APPSC GROUP 1 / GROUP 2 — HISTORY

Volume 3: Modern India (1757–present) — explained from the basics

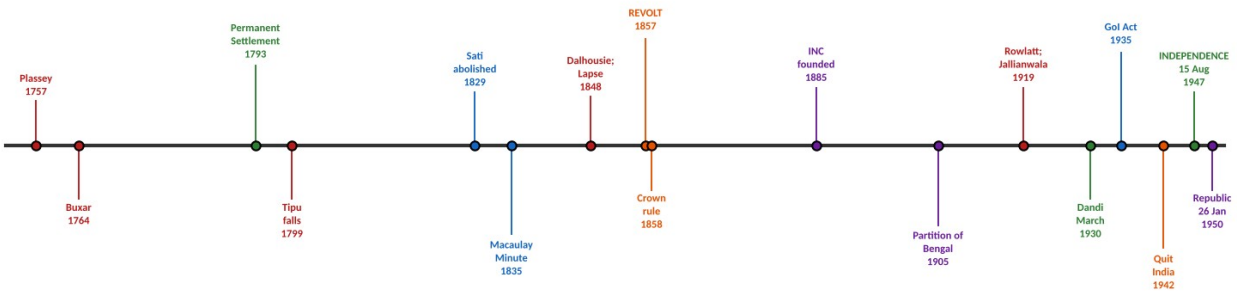
Europeans and British expansion · Company rule and economy · Social reform · The Revolt of 1857 · Rise of nationalism · Gandhian movements and revolutionaries · Independence, Partition and integration · India after 1947

READ THIS FIRST

How to use this volume:

1. Colours: **Blue** = simple explanation · **Orange** = Andhra / Kurnool link · **Red** = exam traps · **Green** = 2-minute revision · **Purple** = self-test.
2. Modern India is the **highest-weight** History block in Prelims and Mains Paper II. Learn the **order of events first**, then the persons, then the numbers.
3. **Who's who tables** give each person's one-line hook (text only; no drawn portraits).
4. Plan: 8 chapters in 8 days; green boxes again on day 3 and day 9; then the self-test and History Mock Test 3.
5. Facts after 2019 are marked LATEST; verify them before the exam. Andhra links (Alluri, Prakasam, Sriramulu, Kurnool) are in Volume 4.

Modern India on one page (timeline)



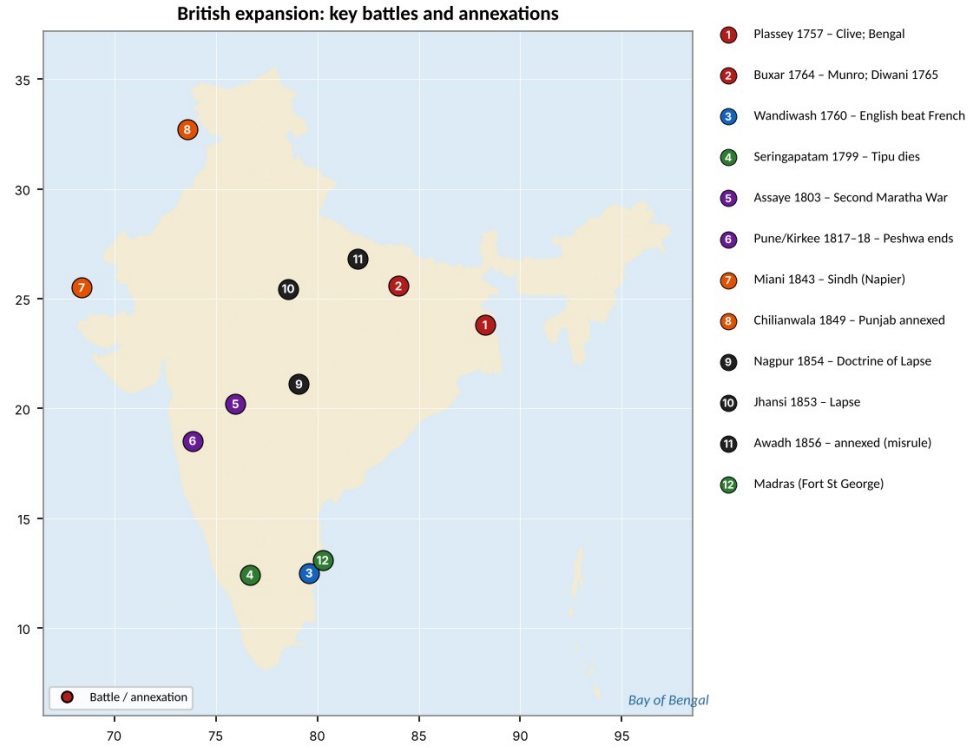
CHAPTER 1 — Europeans and British Expansion (1498–1856)

From trading posts to rulers of India

IN SIMPLE WORDS (what / how / why)

Europeans came for **spices, cotton cloth and silk**. The **Portuguese** came first (1498), then the **Dutch, English and French**. The English **East India Company** won because it had better ships, a trading-company money system, the backing of Parliament and, above all, a divided India — it used quarrels among Indian rulers and then **subsidiary alliances** to take control.

Map: key battles and annexations



Year	Event
1498	**Vasco da Gama** reaches **Calicut**; **1510 Albuquerque** takes **Goa** (Portuguese capital)
1600–1613	**East India Company** chartered **31 Dec 1600**; **Surat** factory (1608 Hawkins; permission 1613); **Sir Thomas Roe** at Jahangir's court 1615
1639–1690	**Madras** (Fort St George) 1639; **Bombay** passed to the Company 1668; **Calcutta** founded by **Job Charnock 1690**; **Pondicherry** (French) 1674
1746–63	**Three Carnatic Wars** (English v French; **Dupleix**). Decided at **Wandiwash (1760)** — **Eyre Coote** beat **Lally**; **Treaty of Paris 1763**
1757	**Battle of Plassey (23 June)**: **Clive** v **Siraj-ud-Daulah**; **Mir Jafar's** betrayal; Company becomes political power
1764–65	**Battle of Buxar (22 Oct 1764)**: Company beat **Mir Qasim, Shuja-ud-Daulah, Shah Alam II**. **Treaty of Allahabad 1765**: **Diwani** (revenue rights) of Bengal, Bihar, Odisha to the Company; **Dual Government** (Clive) until 1772

Mysore, Marathas and the Subsidiary Alliance

War	Key facts
Anglo-Mysore Wars (Hyder Ali, Tipu Sultan)	**1st 1767–69** Treaty of Madras · **2nd 1780–84** (Hyder died 1782; **Treaty of Mangalore 1784**) · **3rd 1790–92** (Cornwallis; **Treaty of Seringapatam 1792**: Tipu lost half his kingdom) · **4th 1799** (Wellesley): Tipu killed; Mysore restored to the Wodeyars under a subsidiary alliance
Anglo-Maratha Wars	**1st 1775–82** (**Treaty of Salbai 1782**) · **2nd 1803–05** (after **Treaty of Bassein 1802** with Peshwa Baji Rao II; Assaye, Laswari) · **3rd 1817–18** (Hastings): **Peshwaship abolished**, Baji Rao II pensioned to Bithur
Subsidiary Alliance (Wellesley, 1798)	Ruler keeps a **British force at his cost**, accepts a **British Resident**, gives up foreign relations and may not hire other Europeans. First **Hyderabad (1798)**, then Mysore 1799, Awadh 1801, Peshwa 1802, Scindia and Bhonsle 1803
Doctrine of Lapse (Dalhousie, 1848–56)	A state with no natural male heir **lapsed** to the Company (adopted heirs not recognised): **Satara 1848**, Jaitpur, Sambalpur, **Jhansi 1853**, **Nagpur 1854**. **Awadh 1856** was annexed for 'misrule' instead
Sikhs, Sindh, Burma	**Ranjit Singh** (d. 1839) kept Punjab strong; **Anglo-Sikh Wars 1845–46** (Treaty of Lahore) and **1848–49** (**Punjab annexed 1849**) · **Sindh 1843** (Napier, Miani) · **Burma wars** 1824–26 (Yandabo), 1852, 1885–86

Governors-General at a glance

Governor-General	Known for
Warren Hastings (1773–85)	First GG of Bengal; ended dual government; Regulating Act; Asiatic Society founded 1784 by William Jones
Cornwallis (1786–93)	**Permanent Settlement 1793**; civil services reform ('father of civil services'); judicial and police reform

Governor-General	Known for
Wellesley (1798–1805)	**Subsidiary Alliance**; Fourth Mysore War; Second Maratha War
William Bentinck (1828–35)	**Sati abolished 1829**; thugi suppression; English education (Macaulay); made GG of India by Charter Act 1833
Dalhousie (1848–56)	**Doctrine of Lapse**; **railways 1853**, telegraph, postal system 1854; Wood's Despatch 1854; Public Works Department
Canning (1856–62)	Last GG and **first Viceroy (1858)**; Revolt of 1857; Indian Councils Act 1861

ANDHRA PRADESH / KURNOOL CONNECTION

Andhra link: the **Northern Circars (1765)** and **Ceded Districts (1800)** came to the Company through these very events (Clive's firman; Nizam's subsidiary alliance of 1798/1800). **Kurnool's Nawab** was removed in 1839. Details: Volume 4, Chapter 6.

EXAM TRAPS

Plassey 1757 won by treachery, not by a big battle; **Buxar 1764** was the real military victory.
Diwani 1765 (Treaty of Allahabad) ≠ **Dual Government** (to 1772). **Lapse** = no natural heir; **Awadh** was annexed for misrule.
Subsidiary Alliance (Wellesley); **Doctrine of Lapse (Dalhousie)** — do not swap.

2-MINUTE REVISION

Plassey 1757 → Buxar 1764 → Diwani 1765 → Mysore 1767–99 → Maratha 1775–1818 → Sindh 1843 → Punjab 1849 → Lapse 1848–56 → Awadh 1856. Wellesley = alliance; Dalhousie = lapse + railways.

CHECK YOURSELF

Q. Where was the real decisive Company victory in 1764? **Buxar.** Q. Who started the Subsidiary Alliance? **Wellesley.**

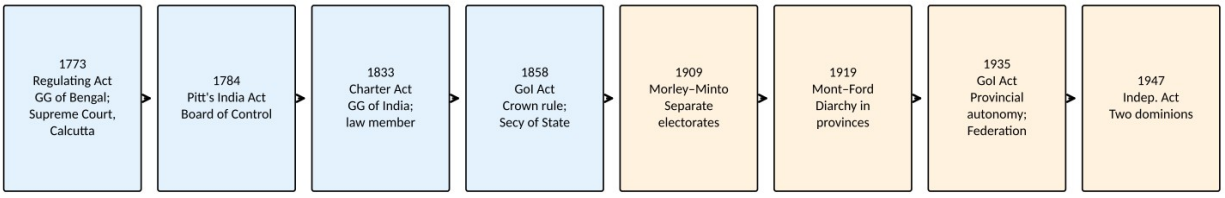
CHAPTER 2 — Company Administration, Economy and Education

Acts, land revenue, drain of wealth, railways and Macaulay

IN SIMPLE WORDS (what / how / why)

The Company first ruled through **Acts of the British Parliament** that slowly took control from the Company (1773–1858). Its **land revenue systems** raised money for the army and trade; but the policies ruined handicrafts and farmers, which Indian leaders later called the **'drain of wealth'**.

Constitutional Acts (1773–1947)



Act	Main points
Regulating Act 1773	**Governor of Bengal → Governor-General** (Warren Hastings); Council of 4; **Supreme Court at Calcutta (1774)**
Pitt's India Act 1784	**Board of Control** (Crown) over political matters, Court of Directors for trade: dual control
Charter Acts 1813, 1833, 1853	**1813:** trade monopoly ended (except tea, China); ₹1 lakh for education · **1833: GG of India**, law member (Macaulay), Company becomes administrative body · **1853:** open competition for civil services
GoI Act 1858	After the Revolt: **Crown rule**; Company abolished; **Secretary of State for India** with a council; Governor-General = **Viceroy**
Indian Councils Acts 1861, 1892	**1861:** Indians nominated to legislative councils; portfolio system · **1892:** limited **indirect election**, right to ask questions
Morley–Minto Reforms 1909	**Separate electorates for Muslims**; larger councils; one Indian on the Viceroy's council (S.P. Sinha)
Montagu–Chelmsford 1919	**Diarchy in provinces** (reserved/transferred subjects); bicameral Centre; separate electorates extended; 10-year review → Simon Commission
GoI Act 1935	**Provincial autonomy**, proposed All-India Federation (never started), Federal Court, RBI (1935), Federal/Provincial/Concurrent lists — a base for the 1950 Constitution
Indian Independence Act 1947	Two dominions from **15 Aug 1947**; princely states lapse of paramountcy; Constituent Assemblies as legislatures